division, a couple of artillery brigades, an air defence brigade, a para battalion, an engineer brigade, signal regiments, electronic warfare elements, a special forces unit, army aviation units and the air force projecting its firepower and its transport and heavy drop capabilities, and the entire gamut of logistics units, including a nuclear, biological and chemical decontamination unit being fielded for the first time. In this exercise the air force was co-opted from the inception and planning stage, right through to the conflict termination phase. This exercise was a rare occasion when the parachute battalion was dropped at night with the chief of army staff and other top brass witnessing it. This was one of the largest exercises since 'Brass Tacks' held during the late 1980s. The GoC-in-C, Lieutenant General P. Joshi, was present for the major part of the exercise. The media was allowed unprecedented access to actions taking place. It was a 'media blitz' aimed at sending a message to Pakistan, as noted by analyst Vikram Vyas.

The plethora of equipment we possessed was put to test not only in the offensive manoeuvres, but had to withstand the harsh conditions of immense heat and sand storms. Modern warfare has brought in heavy reliance on technology. I wondered how the IT experts got the computers and the network connectivity going in such high temperatures and sandstorms where the fine dust permeated into every space. I was constantly worried about the missile storage and resupply, which needs a sanitized, dustproof and cool environment. Each modern gadget or gizmo that contributes to efficiency needs power supply, and we had to face the challenge of making it work in a highly mobile environment. The total wattage produced by all the generators required to keep the Strike Corps energized, could easily meet the needs of a small town in India. The corps of EME (electronic and mechanical engineers) smilingly provided what was almost an electricity department to handle the task. The communications were through a 'rolling grid' based on the concept of the commercial mobile phone network that we use extensively today. In our case, it was purely an exclusive military network providing multiple and secure connectivity. I was always through to my HQ even when I was airborne in the helicopter.